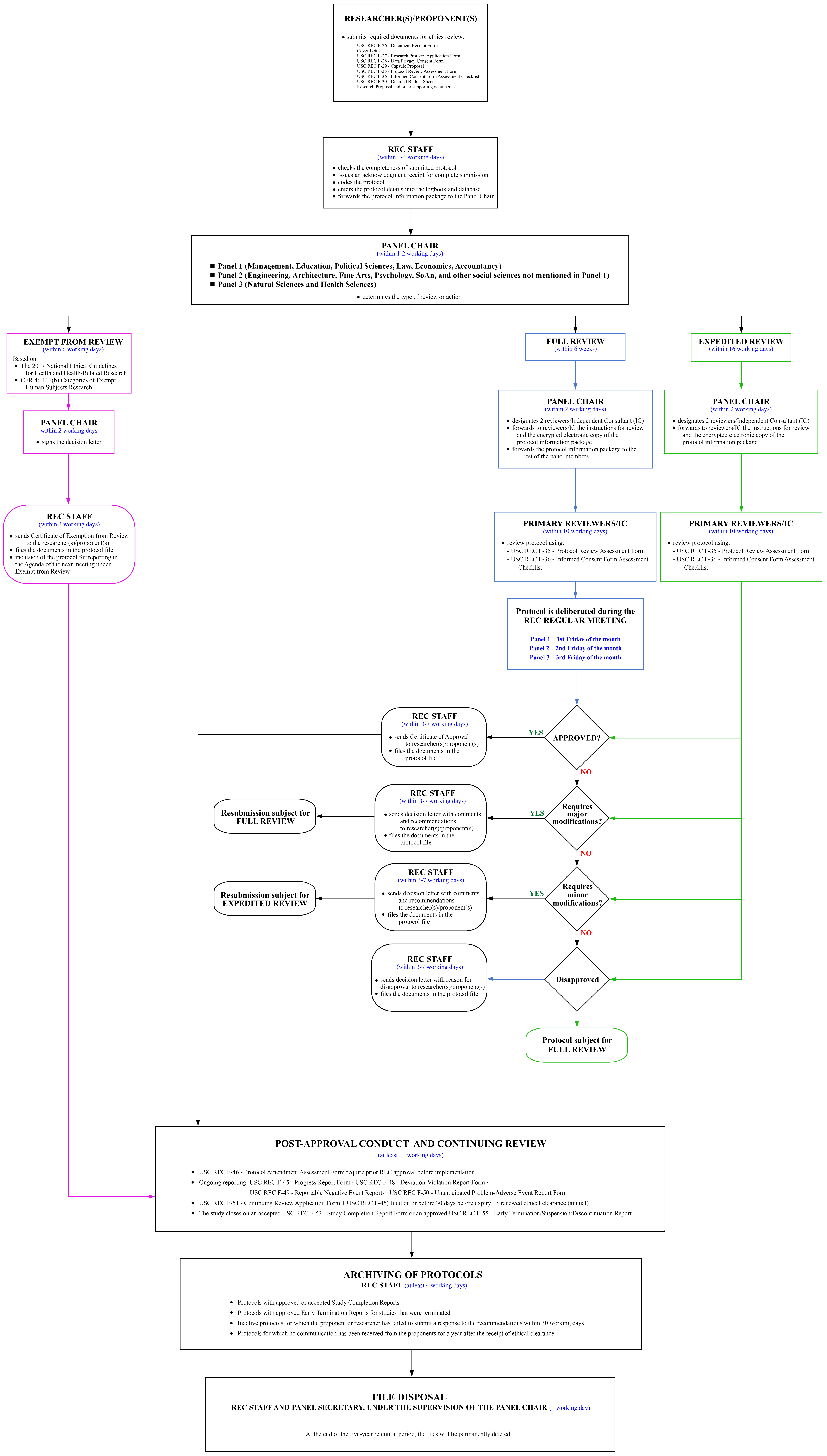
UNIVERSITY of SAN CARLOS
SCIENTIA • VIRTUS • DEVOTIO

RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE

GENERAL FLOW CHART OF PROCEDURES FROM INITIAL SUBMISSION TO FILING OF PROTOCOLS

ver. 07-00/29Sep2026



RESEARCHER(S)/PROPONENT(S)

- submits required documents for ethics review:
  USC REC F-26 - Document Receipt Form
  Cover Letter
  USC REC F-27 - Research Protocol Application Form
  USC REC F-28 - Data Privacy Consent Form
  USC REC F-29 - Capsule Proposal
  USC REC F-35 - Protocol Review Assessment Form
  USC REC F-36 - Informed Consent Form Assessment Checklist
  USC REC F-30 - Detailed Budget Sheet
  Research Proposal and other supporting documents

REC STAFF
(within 1-3 working days)

- checks the completeness of submitted protocol
- issues an acknowledgment receipt for complete submission
- codes the protocol
- enters the protocol details into the logbook and database
- forwards the protocol information package to the Panel Chair

PANEL CHAIR
(within 1-2 working days)

- ■ **Panel 1 (Management, Education, Political Sciences, Law, Economics, Accountancy)**
- ■ **Panel 2 (Engineering, Architecture, Fine Arts, Psychology, SoAn, and other social sciences not mentioned in Panel 1)**
- ■ **Panel 3 (Natural Sciences and Health Sciences)**

- determines the type of review or action

EXEMPT FROM REVIEW
(within 6 working days)

Based on:
- The 2017 National Ethical Guidelines for Health and Health-Related Research
- CFR 46.101(b) Categories of Exempt Human Subjects Research

PANEL CHAIR
(within 2 working days)

- signs the decision letter

REC STAFF
(within 3 working days)

- sends Certificate of Exemption from Review to the researcher(s)/proponent(s)
- files the documents in the protocol file
- inclusion of the protocol for reporting in the Agenda of the next meeting under Exempt from Review

FULL REVIEW
(within 6 weeks)

PANEL CHAIR
(within 2 working days)

- designates 2 reviewers/Independent Consultant (IC)
- forwards to reviewers/IC the instructions for review and the encrypted electronic copy of the protocol information package
- forwards the protocol information package to the rest of the panel members

PRIMARY REVIEWERS/IC
(within 10 working days)

- review protocol using:
  - USC REC F-35 - Protocol Review Assessment Form
  - USC REC F-36 - Informed Consent Form Assessment Checklist

Protocol is deliberated during the REC REGULAR MEETING

Panel 1 – 1st Friday of the month
Panel 2 – 2nd Friday of the month
Panel 3 – 3rd Friday of the month

EXPEDITED REVIEW
(within 16 working days)

PANEL CHAIR
(within 2 working days)

- designates 2 reviewers/Independent Consultant (IC)
- forwards to reviewers/IC the instructions for review and the encrypted electronic copy of the protocol information package

PRIMARY REVIEWERS/IC
(within 10 working days)

- review protocol using:
  - USC REC F-35 - Protocol Review Assessment Form
  - USC REC F-36 - Informed Consent Form Assessment Checklist

APPROVED?

YES

REC STAFF
(within 3-7 working days)

- sends Certificate of Approval to researcher(s)/proponent(s)
- files the documents in the protocol file

NO

Requires major modifications?

YES

REC STAFF
(within 3-7 working days)

- sends decision letter with comments and recommendations to researcher(s)/proponent(s)
- files the documents in the protocol file

Resubmission subject for FULL REVIEW

NO

Requires minor modifications?

YES

REC STAFF
(within 3-7 working days)

- sends decision letter with comments and recommendations to researcher(s)/proponent(s)
- files the documents in the protocol file

Resubmission subject for EXPEDITED REVIEW

NO

Disapproved

REC STAFF
(within 3-7 working days)

- sends decision letter with reason for disapproval to researcher(s)/proponent(s)
- files the documents in the protocol file

Protocol subject for FULL REVIEW

POST-APPROVAL CONDUCT AND CONTINUING REVIEW
(at least 11 working days)

- USC REC F-46 - Protocol Amendment Assessment Form require prior REC approval before implementation.
- Ongoing reporting: USC REC F-45 - Progress Report Form · USC REC F-48 - Deviation-Violation Report Form · USC REC F-49 - Reportable Negative Event Reports · USC REC F-50 - Unanticipated Problem-Adverse Event Report Form
- USC REC F-51 - Continuing Review Application Form + USC REC F-45) filed on or before 30 days before expiry → renewed ethical clearance (annual)
- The study closes on an accepted USC REC F-53 - Study Completion Report Form or an approved USC REC F-55 - Early Termination/Suspension/Discontinuation Report

ARCHIVING OF PROTOCOLS
REC STAFF (at least 4 working days)

- Protocols with approved or accepted Study Completion Reports
- Protocols with approved Early Termination Reports for studies that were terminated
- Inactive protocols for which the proponent or researcher has failed to submit a response to the recommendations within 30 working days
- Protocols for which no communication has been received from the proponents for a year after the receipt of ethical clearance.

FILE DISPOSAL
REC STAFF AND PANEL SECRETARY, UNDER THE SUPERVISION OF THE PANEL CHAIR (1 working day)

At the end of the five-year retention period, the files will be permanently deleted.